

Aurelia Grand Hotel Group

Guest Recovery and Compensation Policy

Remedy authority, evidence standards, refund controls, and service recovery decision rules

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Purpose and usage

This controlled document defines operational standards for hotel teams. It is intended to support consistent decisions, clear accountability, accurate record keeping, and high-quality service recovery across Aurelia properties. Teams must apply local legal requirements when those requirements are stricter than this standard.

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1. Recovery Principles and Severity Model

Guest recovery begins with acknowledgement, fact finding, ownership, and closure. The remedy must be proportional to the verified impact, the stay value, the guest relationship, and the operating risk created by the incident. Teams may not promise compensation before reviewing available records unless a property manager authorizes an immediate goodwill gesture.

Severity level	Definition	Base remedy range
Level 1 - Minor inconvenience	Short delay, amenity omission, service miscommunication with limited impact.	Apology, amenity, points, or value equivalent up to 10% of affected night.
Level 2 - Service failure	Cleanliness, maintenance, or service issue that affects comfort and requires staff correction.	10-30% of affected night, room move, points, dining credit, or approved voucher.
Level 3 - Material stay disruption	Verified room defect, unresolved maintenance issue, or serious cleanliness failure affecting sleep, hygiene, or room use.	One affected night refund, upgrade for future stay, points, or manager-approved package.
Level 4 - Critical incident	Safety, security, discrimination allegation, pest finding, privacy incident, or repeated unresolved defect.	Manager escalation, formal investigation, potential full-stay adjustment, and written follow-up.

Core recovery commitments

- Acknowledge the concern before discussing policy or evidence.
- Verify facts using booking records, room assignment, staff notes, maintenance tickets, housekeeping logs, guest communications, photos, or supervisor inspection.
- Avoid overcompensation for unsupported claims and undercompensation for verified hotel responsibility.
- Record the reason for the decision in plain language so another manager can review the case later.

- Separate financial remedies from operational correction: a refund does not close the case until the root cause has an owner.

Guest impact dimensions

When classifying a complaint, consider duration, severity, preventability, prior notice, staff response, guest vulnerability, room usability, and whether the failure affected sleep, hygiene, safety perception, privacy, or planned activities. A single complaint may involve multiple impacts; the highest supported severity level should guide the first remedy recommendation.

Do not downgrade a complaint solely because the guest remained on property. Some issues, such as a failed air-conditioning unit during the night, may not be immediately correctable and may still materially disrupt the stay.

2. Evidence Standards and Responsibility Findings

A remedy may be approved only when the case file includes enough information to classify the incident as verified, partially verified, unsupported, or inconclusive. A finding may be updated if new information arrives after the initial decision.

Finding	Minimum evidence	Decision guidance
Verified hotel responsibility	Two or more sources support the guest claim, or one authoritative source confirms it. Examples include open maintenance ticket, failed inspection, timestamped photo, supervisor note, or room block record.	Apply the relevant remedy matrix and correct the root cause before closure.
Partially verified	Some facts support the claim but impact, timing, or responsibility is uncertain. Examples include matching staff note without photo, guest photo without metadata, or delay records with unclear duration.	Consider moderate goodwill remedy and request department review if operational weakness is plausible.
Unsupported	Available records contradict the claim and no evidence supports the reported impact.	Offer apology and explanation; do not issue high-value compensation without manager approval.
Inconclusive	Records are missing or inconsistent, or the incident occurred outside normal capture points.	Apply guest relationship and risk judgment; document the uncertainty and assign records improvement task.

Evidence hierarchy

1. Safety or security records and manager incident reports.
2. Maintenance work orders, room block logs, and inspection notes.
3. Housekeeping inspection records and supervisor checklists.
4. Timestamped photos or video received from the guest or staff.
5. Call transcripts, emails, chat records, and staff notes.
6. Guest account history, prior stays, previous complaints, and loyalty profile.

Required case notes

- Complaint summary in the guest's own words when available.
- Affected room, stay dates, booking value, and guest relationship status.
- Evidence sources reviewed and any missing records.
- Responsibility finding and severity level.
- Selected remedy, financial value, approver, and follow-up owner.

3. Compensation Authority and Approval Controls

Remedies must be recorded before posting. Financial remedies require clear approval authority. When the total remedy includes several components, such as refund plus points plus dining credit, the combined value determines approval level.

Role	Maximum authority	Typical use	Restrictions
Front desk associate	EUR 50 equivalent	Amenity, breakfast credit, late checkout, small points posting.	Cannot approve cash refund, card refund, or future-stay certificate.
Guest experience supervisor	EUR 150 equivalent	Voucher, partial night adjustment, points, dining credit.	Requires evidence summary and department owner.
Duty manager	EUR 350 equivalent	One affected night refund, room move, future upgrade.	Must document severity level and root cause task.
Property general manager	Above EUR 350	Full-stay adjustment, repeat guest exception, critical incident remedy.	Finance controller notification required.
Regional operations	Multi-property or legal risk	Media-sensitive, security, discrimination, privacy, group account issues.	Formal case file and legal review if applicable.

Financial posting rules

- Refunds must be tied to the original booking or payment record.
- Loyalty points must not be used to bypass refund limits.
- Vouchers must have expiry date, property scope, transferability status, and approver.
- Duplicate remedies for the same incident require finance controller approval.
- Service recovery costs must be coded to the responsible department when responsibility is verified.

Approval timing

Immediate goodwill gestures may be offered during the stay when they help preserve guest confidence. Larger remedies should be reviewed after evidence collection unless the guest is still on property and the issue threatens comfort, safety, or brand trust. In those situations, the duty manager may approve a provisional remedy and complete the case review before end of shift.

4. Remedy Matrix by Incident Type

The matrix below sets standard ranges. Managers may adjust within authority limits when evidence, guest relationship, stay value, timing, or repeated failures justify a different outcome.

Incident type	Examples	Standard remedy range	Operational follow-up
Cleanliness failure	Dirty bathroom, stained linen, uncollected waste, visible dust, missed refresh.	Level 1-3 depending on severity; amenity to one affected night refund.	Housekeeping supervisor inspection, staff coaching, room release audit.
Maintenance failure	AC not cooling, plumbing defect, broken lock, repeated TV or Wi-Fi issue.	Level 2-4; room move, affected night adjustment, points, or escalation.	Maintenance work order, room block if repeat issue, technician notes.
Room type mismatch	Reserved category unavailable, bed type mismatch, missing accessible feature.	Difference in room value plus goodwill; manager review for accessibility.	Inventory review and booking notes correction.
Noise disruption	Construction, event noise, adjoining room disturbance, plant equipment.	Amenity to partial affected night refund depending on duration and response.	Security or engineering log, room move if recurring.
Service delay	Long check-in, late room readiness, slow response to request.	Apology, points, late checkout, food/beverage credit.	Staffing review and shift handoff note.
Safety/security allegation	Unauthorized entry, harassment, threat, injury, data or privacy concern.	Immediate manager escalation; remedy determined after incident protocol.	Incident report, security review, possible legal notification.

Cleanliness specifics

A serious bathroom cleanliness failure affecting hygiene is normally Level 3 when supported by photo, supervisor inspection, or housekeeping record inconsistency. Minor cosmetic dust or isolated amenity omission is generally Level 1 unless it repeats after staff intervention.

Maintenance specifics

A maintenance defect is more serious when it was reported before arrival, remained open during occupancy, or recurred after a previous repair. AC failures, heating failures, plumbing leaks, lock issues, and power interruptions may require room movement or room block even if the guest accepts compensation.

5. Guest Relationship Adjustments

Guest relationship data is relevant because recovery decisions should protect long-term trust while remaining evidence-based. Loyalty level does not prove a claim, but it may influence urgency, manager involvement, and remedy selection once the impact is supported.

Guest condition	Adjustment guidance	Documentation required
First-time guest	Use normal remedy matrix; preserve brand trust with clear explanation.	Booking value, issue summary, selected remedy.
Repeated guest with positive history	Consider moderate uplift when hotel	Prior stay count and absence of

	responsibility is verified.	repeated abuse indicators.
VIP or high-value account	Escalate to duty manager; consider future-stay upgrade or tailored follow-up.	Loyalty status or account owner note.
Guest with repeated compensation claims	Review previous cases before approving high-value remedy.	Prior claim pattern and manager decision note.
Group, corporate, or travel agency booking	Coordinate with account owner before large financial adjustment.	Group contract or agency terms.

Goodwill without verified responsibility

Goodwill may be used to maintain the relationship where facts are inconclusive but the guest impact is credible. Goodwill must be modest, labeled as goodwill in the case notes, and should not imply liability for unsupported allegations.

6. Escalation, Exceptions, and Abuse Controls

Escalation protects guests, staff, and the company when a case involves high financial value, safety implications, legal exposure, or repeated operational failure. Exceptions must be specific and should not create informal local policy.

- Escalate immediately for safety, security, discrimination, privacy, pest, injury, media, legal, or executive complaints.
- Escalate when total remedy exceeds local authority limits.
- Escalate when records contradict each other or records appear altered, missing, or incomplete.
- Escalate when the same room has three or more similar defects within 30 days.
- Escalate when a guest requests compensation before describing the operational issue.

Potential abuse indicators

- Repeated claims across several properties with similar wording.
- Refusal to provide basic booking information.
- Request for cash-equivalent remedy disproportionate to the issue.
- Photos that do not match room layout, date, or reported issue.
- Aggressive threats tied directly to compensation demands.

Abuse indicators are not grounds to dismiss a complaint automatically. They require manager review, careful language, and evidence-based documentation.

7. Case Closure and Quality Review

A case is closed only when the guest response, financial remedy, department action, and case note are complete. For verified hotel responsibility, the closure must include the operational owner responsible for preventing recurrence.

Closure item	Required before closure	Owner
Guest communication	Apology or explanation sent; remedy stated clearly where applicable.	Guest Experience
Financial record	Refund, voucher, or points posted with approver and code.	Finance / Front Office

Root cause task	Maintenance, housekeeping, or service task created and assigned.	Department head
Manager review	Required for Level 3 or 4, high-value remedies, or VIP exceptions.	Duty manager / General manager
Learning note	Trend, training issue, or process gap recorded if relevant.	Quality manager

Monthly review

Properties must review complaint categories, average remedy value, repeat rooms, repeat defects, closure time, and exception rates each month. Repeated compensation without operational correction must be escalated to the property general manager.

8. Appendix A - Case File Checklist

Every financial remedy must be supported by a case file that can be reviewed without asking the original staff member to explain the decision. The checklist below is used by duty managers and finance controllers during quality review.

Checklist area	Required detail	Why it matters
Identity and stay	Guest name, booking ID, room number, arrival and departure dates, booking value.	Confirms the remedy belongs to the correct stay.
Complaint statement	Summary of what the guest reported and when the report was received.	Preserves the original issue and timeline.
Evidence reviewed	Booking record, maintenance ticket, housekeeping record, photos, call note, email, manager inspection.	Shows the decision was not based on one unsupported statement.
Impact classification	Severity level, affected night, and service category.	Links remedy to the approved matrix.
Approval	Approver name, role, value limit, and timestamp.	Supports financial control and audit.
Operational owner	Department responsible for corrective action and due date.	Prevents compensation from replacing root-cause correction.

If any required field is missing, the case may still proceed in urgent circumstances, but the missing evidence must be noted and assigned for follow-up. Missing records should not be silently ignored.

9. Appendix B - Remedy Examples and Boundary Cases

Case pattern	Recommended decision	Boundary guidance
Guest reports AC failure; maintenance log confirms open ticket before arrival.	Level 3; one affected night refund or equivalent remedy.	Escalate if same room had repeat HVAC tickets within 30 days.
Guest reports dirty bathroom; photo and supervisor inspection confirm.	Level 2 or 3 depending on severity; reclean, room move, partial refund.	Bathroom hygiene failures should not be treated as cosmetic.
Guest requests full refund for 20-minute check-in delay.	Level 1; apology and small amenity if needed.	Full refund is disproportionate unless delay caused missed event or VIP

		breach.
Guest claims noisy room but no call, no log, no pattern, and no supporting record.	Unsupported or inconclusive; apology and note for future room preference.	Consider goodwill for high-value guest if tone and history support it.
Guest moved rooms after broken lock discovered.	Level 3 or 4 depending on safety risk; manager review.	Security-sensitive defects require incident-level documentation.
Repeat guest with many prior compensation claims reports vague issue after checkout.	Manager review before remedy.	Do not accuse; request specifics and review previous cases.

Boundary cases should be discussed in daily operations meetings when they reveal inconsistent standards, missing records, or unclear authority. The goal is not to reduce remedies; the goal is to make remedy decisions defensible and fair.